Newsletter Openprovider

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Dear customer,

This special newsletter is dedicated to the General Data Protection Regulation or GDPR for short. In this newsletter we will inform you about changes related to the GDPR. The good news is: you probably won't need any technical changes on your side to continue working with Openprovider.

This newsletter informs you about:

- Our data processing agreement
- The changes to the whois
- The changes to the gTLDs transfer processes
- The changes towards .de and .uk local presence services
- The changes in domain contacts

Our data processing agreement

Last week, we have published our data processing agreement in the control panel. The data processing agreement explains which data we collect for what purposes and defines your (being the controller) and our (being the processor) responsibilities with respect to personal data of the data subject.

If you did not already do so, please log in to your control panel, review the agreement and simply click to accept it.

Changes to the whois

More and more registries and registrars are adjusting their whois servers in order to comply with GDPR. For the “thin” registries .com and .net, Openprovider runs the whois on whois.registrar.eu. Before the 25th of May, we will remove all person-related data except:

- The owner’s company name (if available)
- The owner’s state/province
- The owner’s country
- The e-mail addresses of owner, administrative and technical contact will be replaced by a web form.

Changes to the gTLD transfer process

This week, ICANN has adopted a set of proposed changes to the gTLD transfer policy. In short: the initial transfer confirmation e-mail (“FOA”) will not be required in all cases anymore and it may become very important for the domain holder to approve outgoing transfer e-mails.

Read more

Changes towards .de and .uk local presence

Two registries that require a local presence for registration of a domain (also called a trustee contact or domicile) have announced changes to that policy as a result of the GDPR: DENIC (.de) and Nominet (.uk).

Read more

Changes to the domain contacts

All registries have reviewed the personal data that they collect. Some registries have decided that not all data is required anymore, and they will skip certain contact types. In the Openprovider control panel, you will see those changes around the 25th of May: for some extensions not all contact fields will be visible anymore. API users are not affected: any provided contact that is not required will be ignored.

The following registries have announced their changes already:

- **NIC AT (.at)** will remove the administrative contact.
- **DENIC (.de)** will remove the administrative and technical contacts.
- **Ficora (.fi)** will remove the administrative contact, and not allow private individuals for the technical contact anymore.
- **NIC LT (.lt)** will remove the technical contact; from the 1st of December 2018, the company registration number will be required for legal entities.
- **IIS (.nu and .se)** does no longer require a VAT number; the corporate identity number or personal identification number remain required.
- **NASK (.pl)** will remove the technical contact. Additionally, the current optional “reason for registration” will be removed.
- **Tldbox GmbH (.versicherung)** removes the administrative contact.

In general, it’s good practice to stop using personal e-mail addresses for administrative and technical contacts for domain names. We advise to rely on role-based e-mail addresses like support@ or webmaster@.

Further information

Remember that we keep updating our knowledge base continuously with new information about the GDPR. The change log in that page allows you to quickly see if things have changed since you last visited.

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